PREP-RASHAN

A Unit of Prep-Rashan Tutorial

DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS - RASHAN

Comprehensive Compilation for UPSC Civil Services Examination

12 November 2026

General Studies Paper I • Paper II • Paper III • Paper IV

Keywords Defined • PYQ (Prelims & Mains) • Practice Questions (Prelims & Mains)

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GENERAL STUDIES PAPER I

[GS-I] Indian Heritage & Culture, History, Geography of the World and Society

GS-I | Geography – Rivers; Places in News (Mapping)

1. The Yamuna: From Yamunotri to Prayagraj – and Delhi's First River Cruise

Syllabus: *GS-I: Drainage systems of India; important geographical features. GS-III: Inland waterways; pollution.*

CONTEXT

The Union Ports, Shipping and Waterways Minister and Delhi's Chief Minister opened Delhi's **first recreational Yamuna cruise** at **Sonia Vihar**, run with a **30-seat electric boat**.



Photo: the Yamuna in Delhi, seen from a Metro train crossing the river.
Photo: Kool Nerd 123, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY 4.0

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Perennial river	A river that **flows all year**, fed by **glaciers, snow and rain**.
Tributary	A **smaller river that joins a larger one** and adds its water.
National Waterway	A river or canal stretch **declared by Parliament** for **inland water transport**, run by the **IWAI**.
IWAI	**Inland Waterways Authority of India** – the body that **develops and regulates** national waterways.
Confluence	The **meeting point** of two rivers – the Yamuna meets the Ganga at **Prayagraj**.

The new cruise (mapping)

- Runs on the **Sonia Vihar–Jagatpur** stretch in **North-East Delhi** – a round trip of about **6 km**.
- A **battery-electric boat** with **30 seats** – quiet and **free of exhaust**.
- Built by the **IWAI** with Delhi agencies; helps run **National Waterway-110** under the **National Waterways Act, 2016**.

- Adds **floating jetties**, online tickets, food courts, play areas, a **musical fountain** and a **light-and-sound show** on the river's legends.

Course of the river

- Rises from the **Yamunotri Glacier** near the **Bandarpunch** peaks, **Uttarkashi** (Uttarakhand), at about **6,387 m**.
- Flows about **1,376 km** – the **Ganga's longest tributary** – and joins it at **Triveni Sangam, Prayagraj**.
- Basin of about **3.66 lakh sq km** across **seven** States/UTs: Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Haryana, Delhi, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh.

Tributaries

- **Right bank: Tons** (its largest Himalayan tributary), **Chambal, Sindh, Betwa, Ken**.
- **Left bank: Hindon, Giri, Rishi Ganga, Hanuman Ganga, Sasur Khaderi**.
- Steep **Himalayan upper course**, slow **alluvial plains** below; monsoon-fed **Chambal and Betwa** add much of the lower flow.

Pollution challenge

- Delhi's **22-km Wazirabad–Okhla** stretch is **under 2%** of the river's length but brings **over 75%** of its **pollution load**.
- Main sources: **untreated sewage** and **industrial waste**.
- River tourism works only if the **water is clean** – sewage treatment comes first.
- **Value addition:** the **Chambal** is home to the **National Chambal Sanctuary** for the **gharial** *(general knowledge)*.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **river origins, tributaries** (right bank vs left bank) and **national waterways**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **river pollution** and **inland water transport**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Which of the following are right-bank tributaries of the Yamuna? 1. Chambal 2. Betwa 3. Hindon 4. Ken. **(Ans: 1, 2 and 4 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "A clean river is the first condition for river tourism." Discuss with reference to the Yamuna in Delhi. (150 words)

GS-I | Society – Urbanisation; Sanitation

2. Swachh Survekshan 2025–26: Navi Mumbai Leads, and Cities Now Mentor Each Other

Syllabus: *GS-I: Urbanisation – problems and remedies. GS-II: Government schemes; local bodies.*

CONTEXT

The **President** gave the **Swachh Survekshan 2025–26** awards at **Vigyan Bhawan**, New Delhi – **60 national awards** to India's cleanest **urban local bodies**.

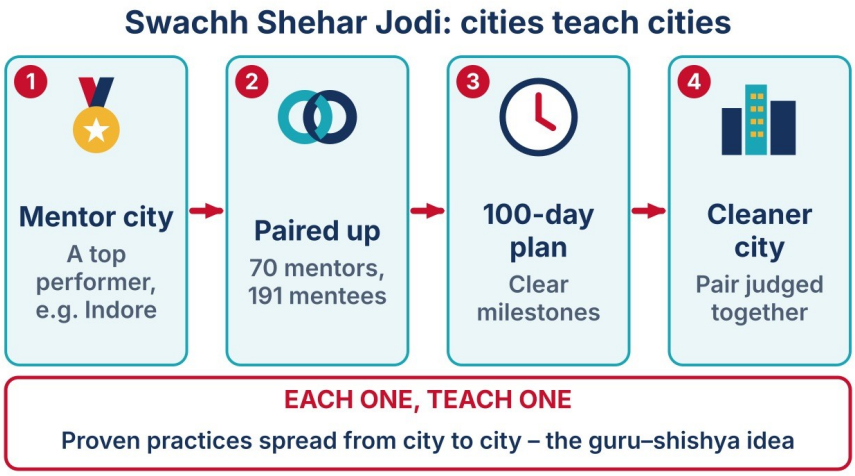


Illustration: how a Swachh Shehar Jodi works – a mentor city guides a mentee city to cleaner streets.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Swachh Survekshan	The **annual cleanliness survey** that ranks Indian cities on **sanitation and waste management**.
ULB	**Urban Local Body** – a municipal corporation, municipal council or town panchayat.
Swachh Shehar Jodi	A **pairing of a mentor city with a mentee city** to share proven cleanliness practices.
Legacy dumpsite	An **old open garbage dump** built up over years, now being **cleared and reclaimed**.
SBM-U	**Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban** – the mission under which the survey is held.

About the survey

- Run under **SBM-U** by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)**.
- Began in **2016** with **73 cities**; the **10th edition (2025–26)** covered **4,751 cities**.
- **43 indicators** in **10 areas**; checked by **3,000+ trained assessors** with GPS tracking and feedback from **2.70 crore citizens**.

Who won

- **Super Swachh League: Navi Mumbai**, **Surat**, **Vijayawada**.

- **Million-plus cities: Visakhapatnam (GVMC)**, **Jabalpur**, **Lucknow**.
- **New categories: Clean Himalayan City – Rudrapur**; **River Front Town – Rewa**; **Coastal Town – Puri**.

Swachh Shehar Jodi

- **70 mentor cities** paired with **191 mentee cities** across **33 States/UTs**.
- Based on **'Each One, Teach One'** – the **guru–shishya** idea; a **100-day joint action plan** with milestones.
- Paid from **SBM-U 2.0 capacity-building funds**; pairs chosen by **performance** and **nearness**.
- **Top pairs: Ahmedabad–Sanand**, **Indore–Depalpur**, **Tirupati–Kuppam**.

Gains and gaps

- **80%** of urban waste processed; **96%+** door-to-door collection; **11,000 acres** freed from **legacy dumpsites**.
- **1,700+ smaller towns** improved their ranks; **350+** jumped over **500 places**.
- **PRAGATI-50: 50 cities** to become technology-driven **Model Clean Cities**.
- Gaps: **used-water management**, **mechanised desludging** and **sanitation worker welfare** need steady funding.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **urban missions**, their **ministries** and **new initiatives**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **solid waste management** and **urban governance**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- The 'Swachh Shehar Jodi' initiative is implemented under: (a) AMRUT (b) Smart Cities Mission (c) Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban (d) PM Awas Yojana–Urban **(Ans: c)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "Peer learning between cities can do what funds alone cannot." Examine with reference to the Swachh Shehar Jodi initiative. (150 words)

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER II

[GS-II] Governance, Constitution, Polity, Social Justice & International Relations

GS-II | Governance – Public Distribution System; Food Security | UPDATE

3. One Nation, One Ration Card: Portable Rations, but Few Migrants Use Them Across States

Syllabus: *GS-II: Government policies and interventions; welfare schemes; e-governance. GS-III: Public distribution system; food security.*

WHAT WE KNOW TILL NOW

- **ONORC** (2019) lets a **National Food Security Act (NFSA)** card holder draw subsidised grain from **any fair price shop** in India.
- It rests on **Aadhaar-seeded ration cards** and **biometric checks** on **e-PoS machines** at the shop.

WHAT TODAY ADDS

- Now in **all 36 States/UTs**, covering **every PMGKAY beneficiary**; about **3.27 crore portability transactions a month**.
- But only **0.7%** of transactions are **inter-State** – migrants use it far less than hoped.
- New digital tools: **SARTHAK-PDS, NIRMAL, SAKSHAM** and **SMART-PDS**.

CONTEXT

A Government update on **One Nation, One Ration Card (ONORC)** shows it now runs in **all 36 States/UTs** – yet **inter-State use** remains **very low**.

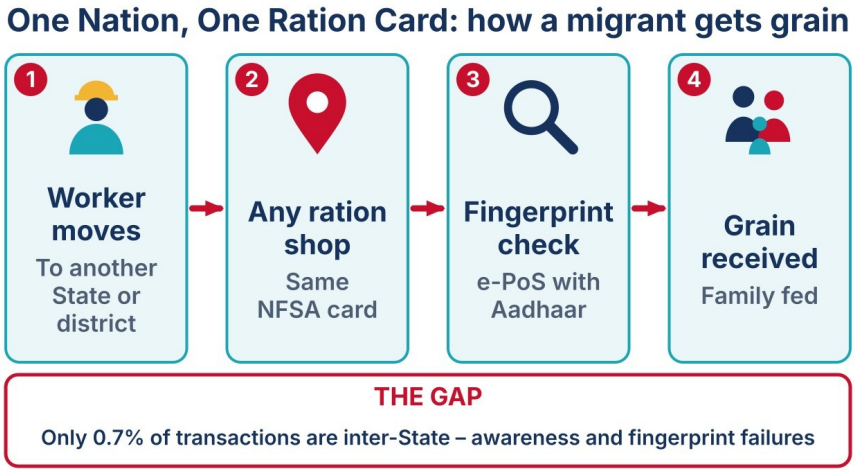


Illustration: how a migrant worker draws subsidised grain from any ration shop – and where the system still breaks.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Portability	The right to **draw your ration from any fair price shop**, not just the one at home.
NFSA	**National Food Security Act, 2013** – legal right to **subsidised foodgrains** for about two-thirds of the population.
e-PoS	**Electronic point-of-sale machine** at a ration shop that **verifies fingerprints** and records each sale.
FPS	**Fair Price Shop** – the local ration shop of the **Public Distribution System (PDS)**.
PMGKAY	**Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana** – the scheme of **free foodgrains** for NFSA households.

Why it matters

- Keeps **migrant workers and their families** fed when they move **within or across States**.
- **Over 233 crore** portability transactions since launch; **614+ lakh tonnes** of grain given out.
- **Mera Ration** app in **13 languages** – check entitlement, history and the **nearest shop**.
- **Digital records** at the shop cut **leakage** and fake entries.

Where it falls short

- **Inter-State use only 0.7%** – many migrants **do not know** they can draw rations elsewhere.
- **Fingerprint failures** for the **elderly and manual workers** – worn prints mean **denied grain**.
- Lists based on **Census 2011** leave out **newly poor** families and migrants **without cards**.
- Shop dealers **hesitate** to serve outsiders – **stock and subsidy settlement** are uncertain; sudden **seasonal demand** causes shortages.

New technology push

- **SARTHAK-PDS:** support for **transport, handling and dealer margins** – food security under NFSA **till 31 March 2031**.
- **NIRMAL:** stronger **data and analytics** for the PDS.
- **SAKSHAM: real-time tracking**, including **vehicle location**, from purchase to the shop.
- **SMART-PDS:** one **central system** for cards, supply chain and **grievances**.

What should be done

- **Offline and alternative authentication** (face, iris or OTP) so no genuine person is turned away.
- **Allocate grain by actual use** and seasonal migration, with **FCI–State warehouse** coordination.
- **Awareness drives** in local languages at **worksites and stations**.
- **Toll-free helplines** and quick **grievance redress**.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about the **NFSA**, **PDS reforms** and **schemes for migrants**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **food security**, **PDS leakages** and **technology in welfare delivery**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Consider: 1. ONORC covers only NFSA beneficiaries. 2. Most ONORC transactions are inter-State. 3. The Mera Ration app is available in 13 languages. Which are correct? **(Ans: 1 and 3 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "Portability has been achieved on paper; it must now reach the migrant." Examine the working of One Nation, One Ration Card. (250 words)

GS-II | Governance / International Relations – Visa Policy

4. India Trims Its Visa Rulebook: 9 Main Categories, a New 'Visitor Visa'

Syllabus: *GS-II: Government policies and interventions; India and its neighbourhood – people-to-people ties. GS-III: Tourism, ease of doing business.*

CONTEXT

The **Ministry of Home Affairs** simplified India's visa system on **27 August 2026** – fewer categories and easier procedures.

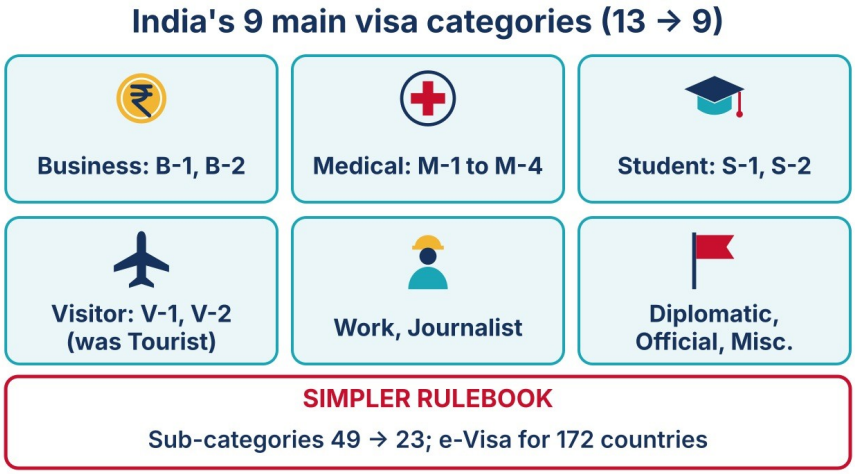


Illustration: the nine main visa categories after the rationalisation, with the new Visitor Visa.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Visa	An official **permission to enter a country** for a stated purpose and period.
Multiple-entry visa	A visa that allows **many entries** during its validity, not just one.
e-Visa	A visa **applied for and granted online** – an **electronic travel authorisation**.
Rationalisation	**Merging and simplifying** overlapping categories to make rules **clearer**.
AYUSH	**Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha and Homoeopathy** – India's traditional systems of medicine.

What changed

- Main categories cut from **13 to 9**; sub-categories from **49 to 23**.
- Follows an earlier round of simplification in **October 2025**.
- Nodal ministry: **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**.

The nine categories

- **Business, Diplomatic, Work, Journalist, Medical, Official, Student, Visitor** and **Miscellaneous**.
- **Tourist Visa** renamed **Visitor Visa**: **V-1** (short-term, **30-day multiple entry** – business meetings, medical consultations) and **V-2** (longer stay – **1, 5 or 10 years**).
- **Business Visa: B-1** (long-term, licence-based) and **B-2** (short-term, contract-based).

Medical and student visas

- **Medical: M-1** (regular treatment), **M-2** (attendant of M-1), **M-3** (**AYUSH** treatment), **M-4** (attendant of M-3).
- **M-1 and M-3** usually give **one-year multiple entry**.
- **Student: S-1** (school to postgraduate study) and **S-2** (research and academic work – PhD scholars, visiting faculty, internships, exchanges).

Why it matters

- **e-Visas** for nationals of **172 countries**.
- Simpler rules help **medical and AYUSH tourism**, **education** and **business travel**.
- Clear categories also help **security screening** and fewer **visa misuse** cases.
- Watch: **processing speed**, **digital access** and **fees** decide the real ease.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **schemes and their nodal ministries** and **new categories** introduced by the Government.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **soft power**, **tourism** and **people-to-people ties**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Under India's rationalised visa regime, the M-3 visa is meant for: (a) Medical attendants (b) AYUSH treatment (c) Medical research (d) Medical conferences **(Ans: b)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- How can a simpler visa regime support India's goals in medical tourism, education and investment? (150 words)

GS-II | Governance – Schemes for Vulnerable Sections; Financial Inclusion

5. Stand-Up India Extended to 2031: Bank Loans for Women, SC and ST Entrepreneurs

Syllabus: *GS-II: Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections. GS-III: Inclusive growth; financial inclusion; employment.*

CONTEXT

The **Union Cabinet** continued the **Stand-Up India Scheme** for **five more years, up to 31 March 2031**, with a target of **at least 2.5 lakh more beneficiaries**.

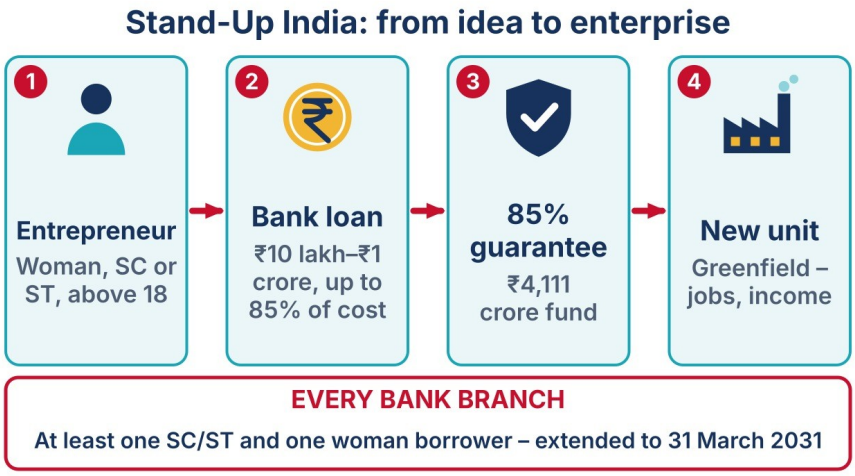


Illustration: how Stand-Up India takes a woman, SC or ST entrepreneur from a bank loan to a new enterprise.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Greenfield enterprise	A **brand-new business** set up from scratch, not an expansion of an old one.
Composite loan	One loan that covers both **term loan** (for assets) and **working capital** (for daily running).
Credit guarantee	A promise by a **guarantee fund to repay the bank** a share of the loan if the borrower defaults.
SCB	**Scheduled Commercial Bank** – a bank listed in the **Second Schedule of the RBI Act**.
Collateral	An **asset pledged** to the bank as security for a loan.

About the scheme

- Launched on **5 April 2016**; run by the **Department of Financial Services**, **Ministry of Finance**.
- Bank loans from **Scheduled Commercial Banks** to **women, SC and ST** entrepreneurs for **new (greenfield)** units.
- So far helped **over 75 lakh** such entrepreneurs (as cited).

Key features

- Loans of **₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore**, covering **up to 85%** of the project cost.

- Borrower **above 18 years**; in a company or firm, **at least 51%** stake held by an **SC/ST or woman** entrepreneur.
- **Manufacturing, services, trading** and **agri-allied** activities.
- **Every bank branch** must back **at least one SC/ST** and **one woman** borrower.

New guarantee support

- **85% credit guarantee** on the loan through the **Credit Guarantee Fund for Stand-Up India**.
- New corpus of **₹4,111 crore**; guarantee fee **0.50%.**
- A **digital portal** offers **handholding** – project reports, skilling links.

Why it matters

- Removes the **collateral barrier** that keeps many **first-generation** entrepreneurs out of banks.
- Builds **self-employment**, **jobs** and **wealth** in **rural and semi-urban** areas.
- Pushes **gender equality** and **social justice** in business ownership.
- Watch: **loan defaults**, **mentoring** and **market access** decide whether new units survive.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **scheme eligibility, loan limits** and **implementing ministries**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **financial inclusion** and **entrepreneurship among marginalised groups**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Consider: 1. Stand-Up India loans are only for expansion of existing units. 2. Loans range from ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore. 3. Every bank branch should support at least one SC/ST and one woman borrower. Which are correct? **(Ans: 2 and 3 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "Credit without collateral is the first step; handholding is the second." Discuss with reference to the Stand-Up India Scheme. (150 words)

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER III

[GS-III] Technology, Economic Development, Bio-diversity, Environment, Security & Disaster Management

GS-III | Economy – Infrastructure: Energy | UPDATE

6. India's 900-GW Clean Power Goal: Cheap Solar Noon, Costly Evenings

Syllabus: *GS-III: Infrastructure – energy; investment models; environment and climate change.*

WHAT WE KNOW TILL NOW

- Solar capacity has risen many times over since 2014; **PM Surya Ghar** has put rooftop solar on lakhs of homes.
- A **₹14,500-crore VGF scheme** backs **92 GWh of grid storage**; experts also want **nuclear** for round-the-clock clean power.

WHAT TODAY ADDS

- **Non-fossil** sources are **54.2%** of installed capacity (June 2026) – but renewables give only about **a quarter** of actual generation.
- About **40 GW** of auctioned solar has **no buyer**; evening prices touch **₹10 a unit** (₹37 in Tamil Nadu).
- The net-zero path is a **$22.7-trillion** investment chance to 2070, with a **$6.5-trillion** gap to fill.

CONTEXT

India aims for **900 GW of non-fossil power capacity by 2035** and **net zero by 2070** – a huge investment opportunity, if **storage, grids and power buyers** keep pace.

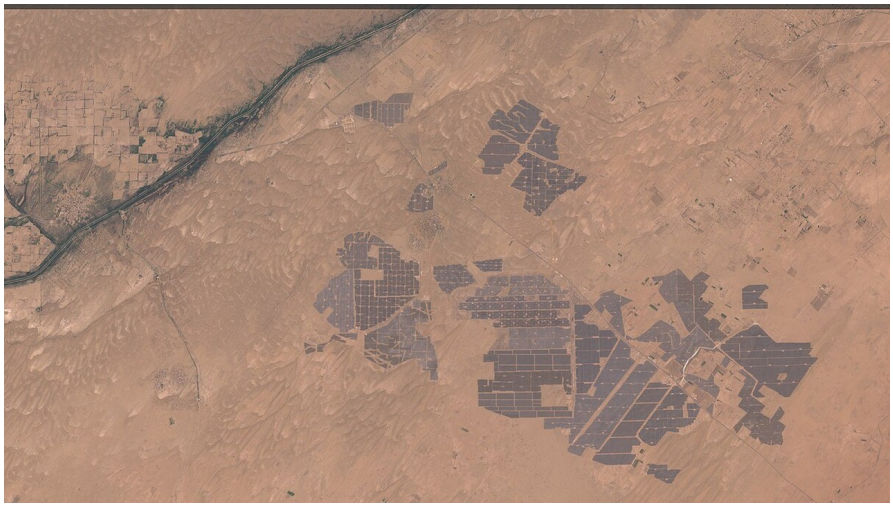


Photo: a satellite view of Bhadla Solar Park in Rajasthan – rows of solar panels across the desert.

Photo: Copernicus Sentinel-2, ESA, Wikimedia Commons, Attribution

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Non-fossil capacity	Power plants that do **not burn coal, oil or gas** – solar, wind, hydro, nuclear and biomass.
Installed vs generated	**Capacity** is what plants **can** produce; **generation** is what they **actually** supply.
Thermal-mimic auction	A tender for **renewables plus storage** that must supply power **like a coal plant – on demand**.
DISCOM	**Distribution company** – buys power and **sells it to consumers**.
Open access	The right of **large consumers** to **buy power directly** from a generator of their choice.

Where India stands

- **Non-fossil** sources: **54.2%** of installed capacity by **June 2026**.
- The **COP26** pledge of **50% non-fossil capacity** was met in **2025** – **five years early**.
- **Solar module** factories grew from about **2 GW** a decade ago to **over 200 GW**; **cells** near **40 GW**.
- About **8 GW** of **open-access solar** came up in **2025**, bought directly by industry.

The mismatch problem

- **Noon:** plenty of solar, exchange prices **near zero**. **Evening:** shortages, prices up to **₹10 a unit**, even **₹37** in Tamil Nadu.
- About **40 GW** of cheap auctioned solar **still has no buyer**.
- **Weak DISCOM finances**, costly loans, **imported battery cells** and **grid gaps** slow the shift.
- New **25–30-year coal contracts** risk **locking in** costly power.

The opportunity

- **$22.7 trillion** of investment to **2070**; domestic money covers **just over 70%**, leaving a gap of about **$6.5 trillion**.
- A **least-cost clean path** could cut power purchase costs by about **15%** – saving **₹2 lakh crore+ a year by 2035**.
- **SECI's 1,000-MW thermal-mimic** tender: **₹5.25–5.26 a unit**, fixed for **25 years**.
- About **200 GW of storage** will be needed to run **900 GW** of non-fossil capacity.

Way forward

- **Technology-neutral auctions** that ask for **peak-hour supply**, not a particular fuel.
- **Time-of-day tariffs** – big discounts at **solar hours**, true cost at **peak**.
- Let new solar and storage use **spare night-time grid connections** of existing plants.
- Build **battery packs, power electronics** and **recycling** at home, even if cells are imported.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **India's climate targets**, **energy schemes** and **renewable terms**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **energy security**, **renewable integration** and **DISCOM reforms**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Consider: 1. India met its target of 50% non-fossil installed capacity in 2025. 2. Renewables supply over half of India's actual electricity generation. 3. A thermal-mimic auction seeks renewable power with storage on demand. Which are correct? **(Ans: 1 and 3 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "India's clean power challenge has moved from building capacity to delivering power when it is needed." Discuss. (250 words)

GS-III | Economy / Science & Technology – Critical Minerals; Circular Economy

7. Black Mass Export Banned: Turning Dead Batteries into Critical Minerals

Syllabus: *GS-III: Indian economy – resource mobilisation; science and technology; environment – waste management.*

CONTEXT

The **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)** has **banned the export** of **lithium-ion battery black mass**, changing its policy from **'Free' to 'Prohibited'** with immediate effect.

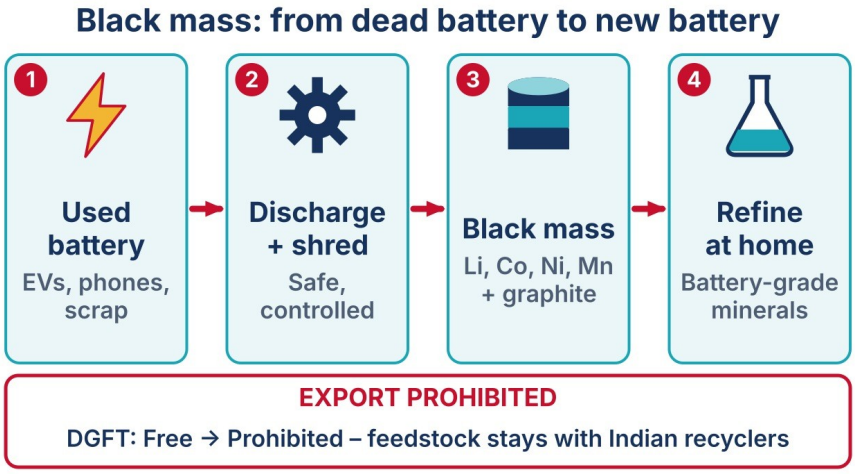


Illustration: how a used battery becomes black mass and then battery-grade minerals at home.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Black mass	A **dark powder** left after **discharging, dismantling and shredding** used lithium-ion batteries – rich in **lithium, cobalt, nickel, manganese and graphite**.
Critical minerals	Minerals **vital for modern technology** whose supply is **scarce or concentrated** in a few countries.
Urban mining	Recovering **metals from discarded products** instead of digging new mines.
EPR	**Extended Producer Responsibility** – makers must ensure their products are **collected and recycled**.
Hydrometallurgy	Recovering metals using **chemical solutions**; **pyrometallurgy** uses **high heat**.

What black mass is

- An **intermediate**, not a finished product – it needs **refining** to give battery-grade materials.
- Makes up about **40–50%** of an **EV battery's weight**.
- Often **richer in metal** than natural ore – less **energy and water** needed to process.
- **Hazardous:** leftover electrolytes such as **$LiPF_6$** pose **fire and toxic** risks; mix depends on chemistry – **NMC, LCO, LFP**.

Why keep it at home

- Gives Indian recyclers a **steady feedstock** – plants now run **below capacity** and even **import** black mass.
- Recycling could meet about **10–12%** of the **lithium** India needs for EV batteries.
- Builds **refining skills** – a stage the world now leaves largely to **China**.
- Cuts **imports** and **foreign exchange** outgo; helps **ACC battery** makers.

Problems today

- Many old batteries go to **landfills** or **informal scrap dealers**.
- **Informal** methods recover only **10–20%** of materials; **formal** plants **over 90%**.
- **Weak collection** from EV users; mixed **chemistries**; plants need **patient capital**.
- Over **87 lakh EVs** on Indian roads by **2025–26** – a big wave of **retired batteries** ahead.

Policy support

- **Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022** – **EPR** and minimum **recycled content** in new batteries.
- **National Critical Mineral Mission** and a **₹1,500-crore incentive scheme** (Sept 2025) for recovery from **battery and e-waste**.
- Next steps: a share of **recycled minerals** in the national **stockpile**, **buy-back** schemes, **quality standards** and **design for recycling**.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **critical minerals**, **battery chemistries** and **waste management rules**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **critical mineral security** and the **circular economy**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Consider: 1. Black mass is a finished battery-grade product. 2. It contains graphite from the battery's anode. 3. India has prohibited its export. Which are correct? **(Ans: 2 and 3 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "Waste batteries are India's newest mine." Examine how battery recycling can strengthen critical mineral security. (250 words)

GS-III | Economy – Taxation; Resource Mobilisation | UPDATE

8. Fewer Exemptions, Wider Base: The Next Round of Tax Reform

Syllabus: *GS-III: Indian economy – mobilisation of resources; government budgeting; growth and investment.*

WHAT WE KNOW TILL NOW

- Foreign investors have been **pulling money out** of Indian shares; experts argue **tax changes** could lift **post-tax returns**.
- Capital gains tax was **raised in 2024**, and **debt funds** are taxed at **slab rates**.

WHAT TODAY ADDS

- **148 goods** (four-digit HSN) still sit **outside GST**; **petroleum** is also out, so taxes **cascade**.
- **GST rationalisation** came in **September 2025**; **simpler tax administration** from **1 November 2026**.
- The Government has signalled a **review of capital gains tax**.

CONTEXT

Economists say India's tax system still has a **narrow base**, **many exemptions** and **distortions** that raise the **cost of capital** – and call for **continuous reform**.

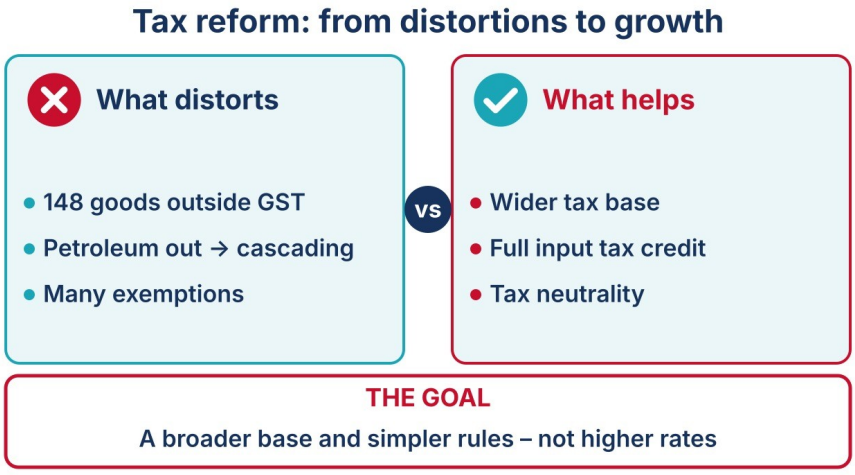


Illustration: what distorts India's tax system today and the fixes that can lift investment.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Tax base	The **total income, goods or transactions** on which tax is levied.
Cascading	**Tax on tax** – when tax already paid on inputs **cannot be set off** and gets built into the price.
Input tax credit	A **set-off for GST paid on inputs** against GST due on sales.
Tax neutrality	A tax system that does **not tilt choices** between firms, sectors or assets.
Economic rent	**Extra profit** earned from scarcity or privilege, **not from extra effort**.

Why reform is needed

- A **wider base** raises revenue without loading existing taxpayers more.
- **Steady revenue** reduces the **fiscal deficit** and **borrowing**.
- **Fewer distortions** lower the **cost of doing business** and attract investment.

Main distortions

- **Exemptions** under GST and income tax treat taxpayers **unequally**.
- **148 goods** (four-digit HSN) outside GST; **petroleum** outside too – **cascading** raises **transport costs**.
- **Composition scheme** (turnover **below ₹150 lakh**) keeps many resellers **out of input tax credit**.
- Different treatment of **domestic and foreign companies**; **transaction taxes** on securities and commodities.

Recent steps

- **GST rationalisation** in **September 2025** removed some distortions.
- Reforms from **1 November 2026** ease **compliance and refunds**.
- Willingness to **re-look at capital gains tax**.

Way forward

- **Cut exemptions** and sector-specific incentives; bring more firms into the **formal tax net**.
- **Extend input tax credit**; deal with **petroleum's** exclusion.
- Keep a **level field** for domestic and foreign firms; **tax economic rents** sensibly.
- Design personal tax to **reward work and saving**; **Centre–State** coordination for a **stable** regime.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **GST features**, **input tax credit** and **types of taxes**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **tax buoyancy**, **GST reforms** and **resource mobilisation**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Consider: 1. Petroleum products are outside GST. 2. Taxpayers under the composition scheme can claim input tax credit. 3. Cascading means tax on tax. Which are correct? **(Ans: 1 and 3 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "The aim of tax reform should be a broader base, not higher rates." Discuss the distortions in India's tax system and suggest remedies. (250 words)

GS-III | Economy – Financial Inclusion; MSMEs

9. Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units Extended to 2031 – With Lower Fees

Syllabus: *GS-III: Inclusive growth; financial inclusion; MSMEs and employment.*

CONTEXT

The **Union Cabinet** extended the **CGFMU** – the guarantee fund behind small collateral-free loans – by **five years, to 31 March 2031**, with a **new ₹5,000-crore corpus**.

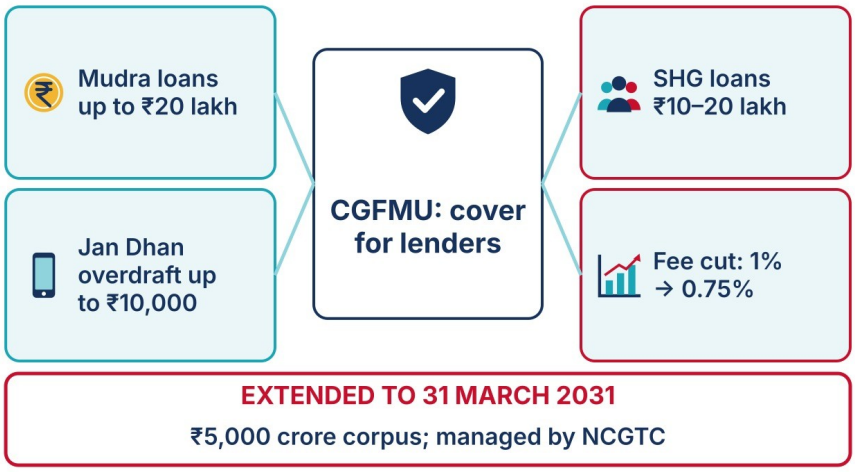


Illustration: how CGFMU covers banks so micro-entrepreneurs get loans without collateral.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
CGFMU	**Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units** – covers lenders against **default on collateral-free micro loans**.
NCGTC	**National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company** – the **Finance Ministry** company that manages it.
MLI	**Member Lending Institution** – a bank or lender covered by the guarantee.
PMMY	**Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana** – **collateral-free loans** for small non-farm businesses.
Portfolio guarantee	A guarantee on a **whole pool of loans**, not loan by loan – **faster claims**.

About the fund

- Launched in **January 2016** to make lending under **PMMY** less risky.
- Managed by the **NCGTC** under the **Ministry of Finance**.
- Under PMMY, **36 crore+ loans** worth **₹43.34 lakh crore** sanctioned till **September 2026**.

What it covers

- **Mudra loans up to ₹20 lakh**, including the new **Tarun Plus** category.
- **Overdrafts up to ₹10,000** in **Jan Dhan** accounts.
- Collateral-free loans to **Self-Help Groups** with a portfolio of **₹10–20 lakh**.

What is new

- Annual guarantee fee for Mudra loans cut from **1.00% to 0.75%**.
- **SHGs: 0.25%** in the first year, **0.50%** after.
- Covers loans from **2026–27 to 2030–31** – in step with the **16th Finance Commission** period.
- Expected to bring **₹12.6 lakh crore** of formal credit over **five years**.

Why it matters

- Takes small borrowers away from **costly moneylenders**.
- Supports **self-employment**, **women's SHGs** and **jobs**.
- Watch: **bad loans** – guarantees must not weaken **careful lending**.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **Mudra loan categories**, **credit guarantee funds** and their **managing bodies**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **financial inclusion** and **credit for MSMEs**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- The Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units is managed by: (a) SIDBI (b) NABARD (c) NCGTC (d) RBI **(Ans: c)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- How do credit guarantee schemes widen access to formal credit? Discuss their risks too. (150 words)

GS-III | Agriculture – Farm Subsidies; Fertilisers

10. Nutrient Based Subsidy for Rabi 2026–27: ₹62,370 Crore for P&K Fertilisers

Syllabus: *GS-III: Direct and indirect farm subsidies; agricultural inputs; soil health.*

CONTEXT

The **Union Cabinet** approved **Nutrient Based Subsidy (NBS)** rates on **phosphatic and potassic (P&K)** fertilisers for **Rabi 2026–27** – **₹62,370.02 crore**, up **₹24,417.73 crore** on the last Rabi.

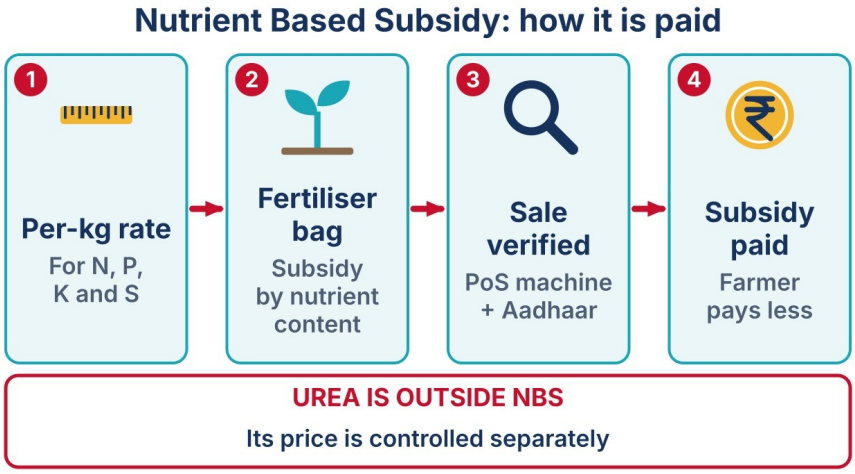


Illustration: how the NBS subsidy is worked out from each nutrient in a fertiliser bag and paid after a verified sale.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
NBS	**Nutrient Based Subsidy** – a **fixed subsidy per kg of each nutrient** (N, P, K, S) in a fertiliser.
P&K fertilisers	**Phosphatic and potassic** fertilisers – such as **DAP, MOP, SSP** and **NPK** mixes.
DAP	**Di-Ammonium Phosphate** – the most used phosphatic fertiliser.
MOP	**Muriate of Potash** – the main source of **potassium**.
Fortified fertiliser	A fertiliser with **added micronutrients** such as **boron or zinc**.

About the scheme

- Run by the **Department of Fertilizers**, **Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers**.
- In force since **1 April 2010**, replacing the older **product-based** concession scheme.
- Covers **N, P, K and S**, with **extra per-tonne support** for **boron and zinc** fortification.
- **Urea is not under NBS** – its price is **controlled** separately.

How it works

- Government fixes a **per-kg rate for each nutrient**; a bag's subsidy follows its **nutrient content**.
- **28 grades** of P&K fertilisers, including **DAP, MOP, SSP** and **NPKS** mixes.
- Companies set the **MRP** within reason; subsidy is paid **after the sale is verified** on **PoS machines** with **Aadhaar** (DBT).

Why it matters

- Aims to fix the **N:P:K imbalance** caused by cheap **urea** and its **overuse**.
- **Shields farmers** from global price spikes of imported P&K inputs.
- Promotes **soil health** and **crop yields**.

Concerns

- With urea outside, **cheap urea** keeps the **imbalance** going.
- High **import dependence** for phosphate and potash raw materials.
- Rising subsidy bill – **₹24,417.73 crore more** than the last Rabi.
- **Value addition:** the **Soil Health Card** scheme guides **balanced fertiliser use** *(general knowledge)*.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **fertiliser subsidy schemes**, **nutrients** and **urea pricing**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **farm subsidies** and **soil health**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Consider: 1. Urea is covered under the Nutrient Based Subsidy scheme. 2. NBS subsidy depends on the nutrient content of the fertiliser. 3. The scheme is run by the Department of Fertilizers. Which are correct? **(Ans: 2 and 3 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "Keeping urea outside the NBS regime undermines balanced fertilisation." Examine. (150 words)

GS-III | Environment – Climate Change; Reports and Indices

11. Climate Change Performance Index 2027: India Slips to 28th

Syllabus: *GS-III: Environment – climate change, conservation; international reports.*

CONTEXT

India fell **five places to 28th** in the **Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2027**, released at **COP31** in **Antalya, Turkey**.

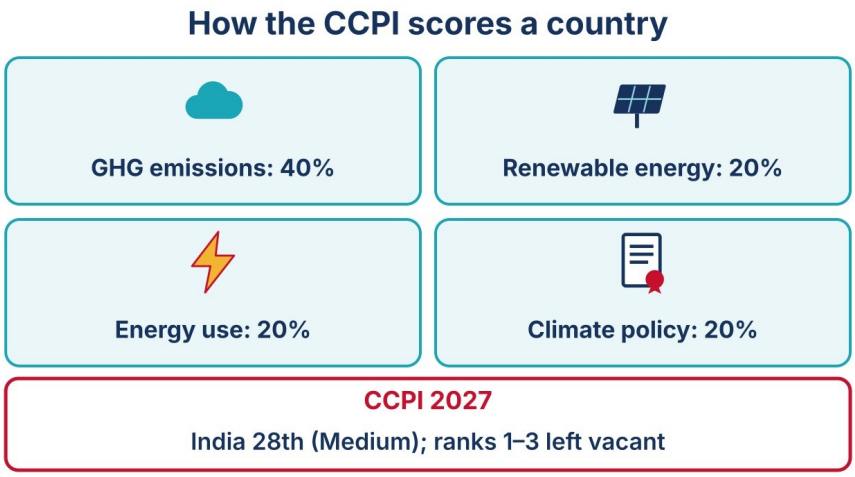


Illustration: how the CCPI scores countries – four categories and their weights.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
CCPI	An **annual ranking of climate action** by major emitters, published since **2005**.
Germanwatch	A German group that publishes the CCPI with the **NewClimate Institute** and **CAN International**.
1.5°C pathway	An emissions path in line with the **Paris goal** of limiting warming to **1.5°C**.
Curtailment	**Switching off renewable output** the grid **cannot take** at that moment.
G20	Group of **19 countries + EU + African Union** – about **three-quarters of global emissions**.

How the index works

- Published by **Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute** and **Climate Action Network (CAN) International**.
- **14 indicators** in four categories: **GHG emissions 40%**, **renewable energy 20%**, **energy use 20%**, **climate policy 20%**.
- Uses data plus views of **450+ national experts**.

Rankings

- **Ranks 1–3 left empty** – no country is on a **1.5°C-compatible** path in all four categories.
- **4th Denmark** (best for the **sixth year**), **5th Lithuania**, **6th Luxembourg**, **7th UK** – the **only G20** country rated **High**.

- At the bottom: **Russia (66)**, **United States (67)**, **Iran (68, last)**.
- **10 G20** economies rated **Very Low**.

India's position

- **28th**, score **60.85**, rating **Medium** – down from **23rd** (CCPI 2026) and **10th** (CCPI 2025).
- **High** rating for **renewable energy** trends – **50% non-fossil capacity** reached **ahead of 2030**.
- But a **gap** between **installed capacity** and **actual clean power**, due to **storage bottlenecks** and **solar curtailment**.

What India can do

- **Storage and grids** so clean power is **used, not wasted**.
- Slow down **new coal**; push **efficiency** in industry and buildings.
- Keep **per-capita emissions** low – a fair point India makes in talks.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks **which body publishes which index** and **India's rank**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **India's climate commitments** and their **implementation**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- The Climate Change Performance Index is published by: (a) UNEP (b) Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute and CAN International (c) World Economic Forum (d) IPCC **(Ans: b)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- India adds clean capacity fast but slips in climate rankings. Explain the gap and suggest remedies. (150 words)

GS-III | Infrastructure – Railways; Disaster Management

12. Sairang Express Derails in Assam: Why Rail Safety Must Be Preventive

Syllabus: *GS-III: Infrastructure – railways; disaster management. GS-II: Accountability in governance.*

CONTEXT

The engine and **five coaches** of the **Kolkata–Sairang Express** (bound for **Mizoram**) **derailed** near **Digaru station** in **Kamrup district, Assam**; officials reported **no deaths**.

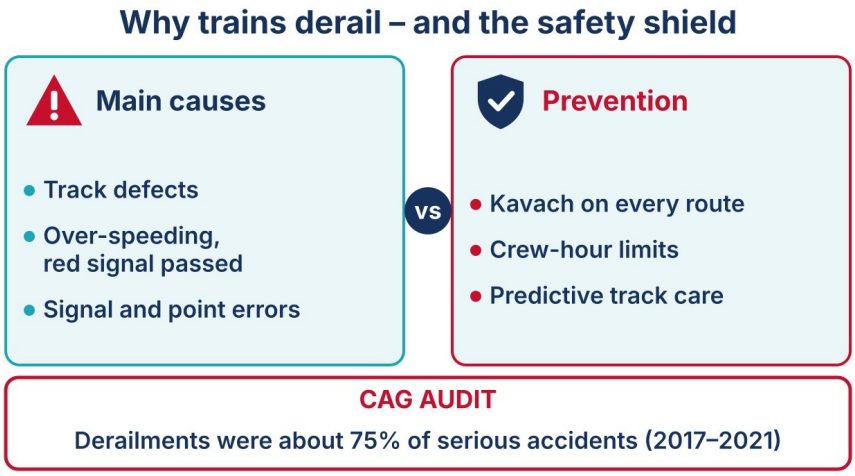


Illustration: the main causes of derailments and the safety shield that can prevent them.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Derailment	When a train **leaves the rails** – the most common serious rail accident in India.
SPAD	**Signal Passing at Danger** – a train running past a **red signal**.
Kavach	India's **own automatic train protection** system that **applies brakes** if the driver over-speeds or passes a red signal.
Loop line	A **side track** at a station where a train waits to **let another pass**.
CRS	**Commissioner of Railway Safety** – investigates serious rail accidents.

What happened

- At about **6:54 in the morning**, while the train was being taken onto a **loop line** to let a **higher-priority train** pass.
- **Northeast Frontier Railway** said the **loco pilot lost control of speed**; claims of **brake failure** are **unverified**.
- Officially **no deaths**; a few minor injuries reported locally.

Why trains derail

- A **2022 CAG audit**: derailments were about **75%** of serious accidents (**2017–2021**).
- **Track defects** – rail fractures, metal fatigue; track machines **idle 16%** of available days.
- **Human error and fatigue** – over-speeding, SPAD; linked to **154** derailments in the audit.

- **Fouled ballast**, heat-caused **rail buckling**, and **signalling or point** errors.

Steps taken

- **Kavach** – India's own **automatic train protection**.
- **Rashtriya Rail Sanraksha Kosh** – a **non-lapsable safety fund** for track and bridge renewal.
- **LHB coaches** with **anti-climb** design replace older **ICF** coaches.
- **Ultrasonic flaw detection** of rails; **electronic interlocking**.

Way ahead

- Fit **Kavach** fast on all busy and **North-East** routes.
- **Cap crew duty hours**; **vigilance devices** that alert tired drivers.
- **Predictive maintenance** and track-recording cars.
- **Time-bound CRS inquiries** – the CAG found **63%** delayed – and a dashboard for follow-up.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **railway safety systems** such as **Kavach** and **safety funds**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **railway modernisation** and **disaster prevention**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- 'Kavach', often in the news, is: (a) A railway cyber-security firewall (b) An indigenous automatic train protection system (c) A coach design for high-speed trains (d) A disaster-relief train service **(Ans: b)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "Rail safety must move from post-accident inquiries to prevention." Discuss with reference to recent derailments. (250 words)

GS-III | Internal Security – Terrorism in J&K

13. Kulgam Checkpoint Attack: The Challenge of Hit-and-Run Militancy

Syllabus: *GS-III: Internal security – terrorism, border management, role of external state and non-state actors.*

CONTEXT

Three CRPF personnel were **injured** when **terrorists on a motorcycle** fired at close range on a **security checkpoint** in **Kulgam district**, Jammu and Kashmir.

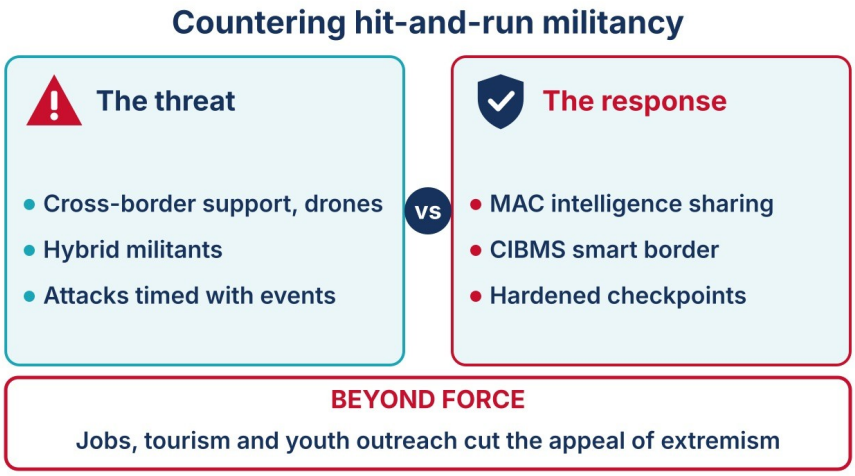


Illustration: how hybrid militants strike and the layers of response that can stop them.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Hybrid militant	A **part-time attacker** with **no police record** who strikes and **returns to normal life**.
OGW	**Over Ground Worker** – a supporter who gives **shelter, money or information** to militants.
MAC	**Multi-Agency Centre** – the platform for **sharing intelligence** among agencies.
CIBMS	**Comprehensive Integrated Border Management System** – **smart fencing**, sensors and radars on the border.
VDG	**Village Defence Guards** – **armed local volunteers** in vulnerable villages.

The attack

- About **30 rounds in 15 seconds** at a **CRPF (46 Battalion)** checkpost; the attackers fled.
- Timed with the **Lieutenant-Governor's visit** to the district for a **cultural festival**.
- **Search operations** launched across **south Kashmir**.

Why such attacks continue

- **Cross-border support** – arms dropped by **drones**, infiltration across the **LoC**.
- **Hybrid militancy** – small, quick strikes by people hard to trace.

- Attacks timed with **official events** to dent the **image of normalcy**.
- **Dense forests** and **mountains** – e.g., the **Pir Panjal** belt – give cover.

Steps taken

- **Zero-tolerance** policy and intelligence sharing through the **MAC**.
- **CIBMS** – smart fencing, thermal imagers, **anti-drone** radars.
- **Village Defence Guards**; **UAPA** and **NIA** action against **terror financing** and **OGWs**.

Way ahead

- **Harden checkpoints** – bulletproof bunkers, **number-plate cameras**, drone overwatch.
- **Human intelligence** through **community policing**.
- **Counter-drone** systems at forward posts.
- **Jobs, tourism and youth outreach** to cut the appeal of extremism.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **security bodies**, **laws (UAPA)** and **border management systems**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **cross-border terrorism** and **internal security strategy** in J&K.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Consider: 1. The Multi-Agency Centre is a platform for intelligence sharing. 2. CIBMS uses smart fencing and sensors along the border. 3. Village Defence Guards are a central armed police force. Which are correct? **(Ans: 1 and 2 only)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "Large militant networks are weaker, but hybrid militancy remains a threat." Discuss the strategy needed in Jammu and Kashmir. (250 words)

GS-III | Security – Coastal Security; Defence Exercises

14. Sea Vigil-26: India Tests Its Whole Coastline Against Threats from the Sea

Syllabus: *GS-III: Security challenges and their management in border areas; linkages of organised crime with terrorism.*

CONTEXT

The **Indian Navy** is leading **Sea Vigil-26**, the **fifth** pan-India **coastal defence exercise**, from **11 to 19 November 2026**.



Illustration: the two phases of Sea Vigil-26 and the agencies that take part.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Coastal security	Protecting the **coastline, ports and nearby waters** from threats such as **infiltration** and **smuggling**.
EEZ	**Exclusive Economic Zone** – sea area up to **200 nautical miles** where India has rights over **resources**.
TROPEX	**Theatre Level Readiness Operational Exercise** – the Navy's major **biennial** war-readiness exercise.
SLOC	**Sea Lanes of Communication** – the main **sea routes** for trade and energy.
Asymmetric threat	An attack by a **small, weaker group** using surprise – e.g., **hijacking or sabotage**.

About the exercise

- Planned in **2018**, first held in **January 2019** – a response to lessons of the **26/11 Mumbai attacks**.
- **Indian Navy** leads; with the **Coast Guard, marine police, Customs, CISF, port authorities** and **fishing communities**.
- Serves as a **precursor to TROPEX**.

Two phases

- **Coastal Defence and Security Readiness Evaluation (CDSRE): 11–17 November** – audits of coastal assets.

- **Sea Phase: 18–19 November** – **simulated threats** at sea.
- Covers the **whole coastline (7,516+ km)** and the **EEZ**, all coastal **States and UTs**, and **islands**.

What it tests

- Response to **infiltration, hijacking**, attacks on **offshore installations** and sabotage of **ports and nuclear sites**.
- **Fisherfolk** as the **eyes and ears** – reporting suspicious activity; **biometric IDs** and **boat transponders**.
- **Joint command** and **information sharing** among agencies.

Why it matters

- Guards **ports, offshore energy**, **undersea cables** and **SLOCs**.
- Links **coastal defence** with **blue-water** operations.
- Finds **gaps** before an adversary does.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks about **defence exercises** – **who leads** and **with whom**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **coastal security architecture** after **26/11**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Exercise Sea Vigil is best described as: (a) A bilateral naval exercise with Sri Lanka (b) A pan-India coastal defence exercise led by the Indian Navy (c) A Coast Guard pollution-response drill (d) A multilateral anti-piracy patrol **(Ans: b)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- How has India's coastal security architecture evolved since 26/11? Assess the role of exercises like Sea Vigil. (150 words)

GS-III | Security / International Relations – Defence Exercises

15. IMNEX-26: India and Myanmar Navies Exercise at Visakhapatnam

Syllabus: *GS-II: India and its neighbourhood. GS-III: Security – maritime cooperation.*

> **CONTEXT**
> The **eighth India–Myanmar Naval Exercise (IMNEX-26)** began at **Visakhapatnam** on **10 November** and runs till **14 November 2026**.

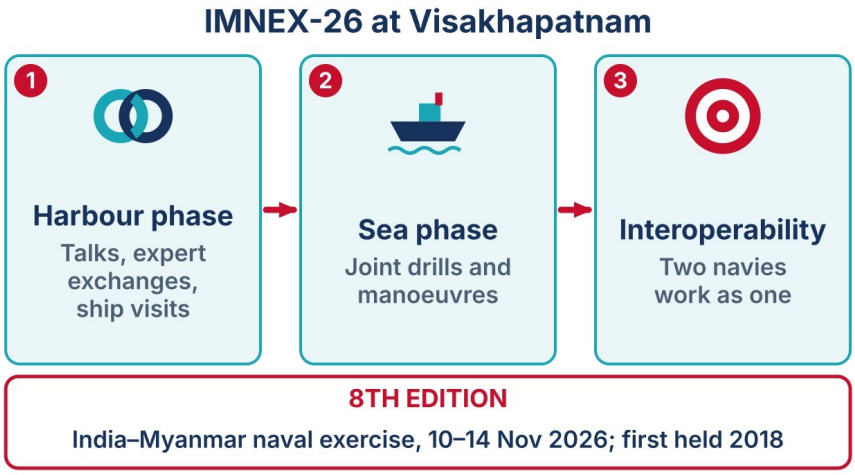


Illustration: the harbour and sea phases of IMNEX-26 and what each builds.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
IMNEX	**India–Myanmar Naval Exercise** – a **bilateral** exercise, first held in **2018**.
Interoperability	The ability of two forces to **work together smoothly** – common drills and communication.
SMEE	**Subject Matter Expert Exchange** – specialists share **know-how**.
Cross-deck visit	Crews **visit each other's ships** to learn their systems.
IMBAX	**India–Myanmar Bilateral Army Exercise**.

About the exercise

- A **bilateral** naval exercise between **India and Myanmar**; first held in **2018**.
- **2026 edition – the 8th** – hosted by **India** at **Visakhapatnam**, **10–14 November**.

Phases

- **Harbour phase:** professional talks, **SMEEs**, **cross-deck visits**, sports.
- **Sea phase:** joint operations, **tactical manoeuvres** and drills for **interoperability**.

Why Myanmar matters

- Shares a **land border** with four North-Eastern States and a **sea boundary** in the **Bay of Bengal** *(general knowledge)*.
- Key to the **Act East Policy** and connectivity such as the **Kaladan** project *(general knowledge)*.
- Navy-to-navy ties help **maritime security** and **disaster response** in the Bay.

Other ties

- **IMBAX** – the **army** exercise between the two countries.
- Joint work helps against **insurgent groups** and **smuggling** on the border.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- **Pattern:** Prelims asks to **match exercises with partner countries**.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** Mains asks about **India–Myanmar relations** and **Act East**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- IMNEX is a naval exercise between India and: (a) Indonesia (b) Myanmar (c) Malaysia (d) Maldives **(Ans: b)**

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- Discuss the strategic importance of Myanmar for India's Act East Policy and security of the North-East. (150 words)

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER IV

[GS-IV] Ethics, Integrity & Aptitude

GS-IV | Ethics – Leadership, Institutions and Accountability

16. Ethics Synthesis: When a Leader Becomes Indispensable, the Institution Becomes Fragile

Syllabus: *GS-IV: Ethics in public and private institutions; corporate governance; leadership; accountability. Essay: individual vs institution.*

CONTEXT

Investors in a **leading AI-chip company** began asking whether it could stay stable **without its famous chief** – a worry called **'key-man risk'**.

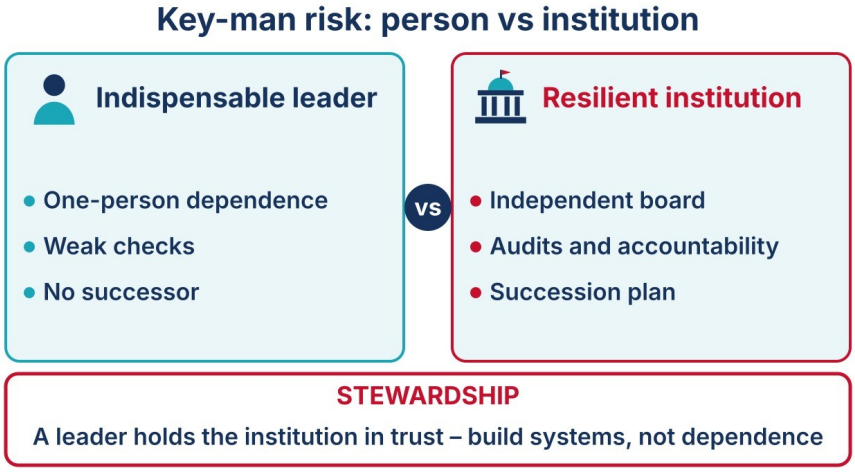


Illustration: the key-man risk – and the institutional safeguards that make an organisation outlast any one leader.

KEYWORDS DEFINED

Keyword	Meaning
Key-man risk	The danger of an organisation **depending too much on one person**.
Succession planning	Preparing **future leaders** in advance so work goes on **smoothly**.
Institutional resilience	The ability of an institution to **survive shocks** and **leadership changes**.
Accountability	The duty to **answer for decisions** to those affected – boards, shareholders, the public.
Cult of personality	**Blind devotion to a leader** that silences questions.

The issue

- **Visionary leaders** can build great organisations – and also become their **biggest weak point**.
- **Heavy dependence** weakens **checks, accountability** and **succession**.
- Seen in companies, **political parties**, **civil services** and **NGOs** alike.

Ethical questions

- Should **boards** challenge a successful leader, or **defer** to success?
- Is **excessive pay or power** justified by **indispensability**?
- Does **personal conduct** of a leader become a **public concern**?

Values at stake

- **Accountability** and **transparency** – no one above scrutiny.
- **Humility** – leaders build systems, not **dependence on themselves**.
- **Integrity** – the same standards **in private and public** life.
- **Stewardship** – a leader holds the institution **in trust** for others.

Lessons for public life

- **Rules over rulers** – strong institutions need **processes, not personalities**.
- **Independent boards**, **audits** and **term limits** check concentration of power.
- **Mentor successors** – in the spirit of **'Each One, Teach One'**.
- Gandhiji built **movements**, not a **personal following** – leadership as **service** *(general knowledge)*.

PYQ – PRELIMS

- Not applicable for Prelims – use these values in GS-IV.

PYQ – MAINS

- **Pattern:** GS-IV asks about **leadership qualities**, **accountability** and **ethics in institutions**.

FQ – PRELIMS (Possible Question)

- Not applicable for Prelims – use these values in GS-IV.

FQ – MAINS (Possible Question)

- "The real test of a leader is whether the institution flourishes after the leader leaves." Discuss. (150 words)



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